Recheck & improved model v2 — match totals (both teams combined)

Flagged results: FC Gifu v Fukushima United FC finished **1–0** and Tochigi City v Yokohama FC finished **1–1**. Both were OVER picks and both missed on a 'more than 2 goals' line. Tochigi's 2 goals only satisfied the looser '2 or more' wording — that wording is now dropped: OVER means total ≥ 3, UNDER means total ≤ 3.

What the first model missed (found in the recheck): (1) It trusted 9–10-game scoring rates at face value — early-season goals are mostly noise, so one freak result (e.g. Gifu's 7–0, Tochigi City's 5–0) badly inflated a team's rating. (2) Plain Poisson under-prices exactly the scorelines that occurred: 0–0 and 1–1. (3) It used overall goals for/against with no regression to the league mean and no home/away split. (4) It labelled 85–96% probabilities on that shaky base — overconfident.

Fixes in v2: (a) shrinkage of every team's scoring rate (4-game prior) and conceding rate (6-game prior) towards the league average; (b) Dixon–Coles low-score correction (rho = –0.10), which moves probability onto 0–0/1–1; (c) much stricter bars: OVER needs P(total ≥ 3) ≥ 72%, UNDER needs P(total ≤ 3) ≥ 92%. Under v2 the Tochigi match is **no longer a pick at all** (68.3%). Gifu still rated high (80.1%) and still lost — even a genuine 80% chance fails 1 time in 5.

On 'at least 90% accuracy': no honest model can promise that on goals markets. Published benchmarks put good over/under models at roughly 55–60% accuracy overall, and Dixon–Coles improves on plain Poisson by only ~1–3%. The only legitimate route towards ~90% is to pick extremely rarely, only where the computed probability itself is around 90%+ — and even then, 1 in 10 such picks fails. Any sheet promising 90% across many matches is not being straight with you. This sheet therefore lists very few picks rather than many.

Revised v2 ratings — remaining Sunday 18 Oct matches

Sunday match (not yet played)	xG total	P(total 3+)	P(total ≤3)	v2 verdict
Juve Stabia v Sudtirol Serie B · Sun 18 Oct 15:00 CEST	2.07	34.3%	84.4%	No pick — not confident enough
Juventus v Lazio Serie A · Sun 18 Oct 18:45	2.14	36.1%	83.1%	No pick — not confident enough
Nottingham Forest v Arsenal Premier League · Sun 18 Oct 15:30	2.27	39.5%	80.6%	No pick — not confident enough
Cesena v Avellino Serie B · Sun 18 Oct	2.74	51.6%	70.5%	No pick — not confident enough
Halmstad v Hammarby Allsvenskan · Sun 18 Oct 14:30	2.89	55.2%	67.2%	No pick — not confident enough
Sampdoria v Arezzo Serie B · Sun 18 Oct	2.97	57.1%	65.3%	No pick — not confident enough
SC Cambuur v AZ Alkmaar Eredivisie · Sun 18 Oct 12:30	3.34	64.8%	57.2%	No pick — not confident enough
Machida Zelvia v Avispa Fukuoka J1 League · Sun 18 Oct 07:00	3.31	64.3%	57.7%	No pick — not confident enough

No Sunday match clears the v2 bars, so the honest revised sheet has **no new confident pick** for Sunday. The closest are SC Cambuur v AZ Alkmaar (64.8% for 3+) and Machida Zelvia v Avispa Fukuoka (64.3%) — both well short of the bar, so both are dropped.

Method sources: Dixon & Coles (1997) low-score correction; early-season shrinkage research (only ~42% of a team's early scoring rate and ~25% of its conceding rate persists); published over/under model benchmarks (~55–60%). Inputs remain real league tables only — no copied predictions. Analysis only, not betting advice.